





We believe a home is rarely experienced in a single, sweeping glance. Instead, it is discovered through a sequence of small, intimate moments: turning a corner, catching a glimpse of a sunlit room, hearing familiar footsteps in the kitchen or settling into a favourite armchair by the window. Over time, these subtle daily interactions form our lasting memories of a space. When we were commissioned to design A Southern Tableau, a 10,000 sq ft residence in Chennai, we anchored our entire architectural approach to this idea of gradual discovery. Built for a multi-generational Rajasthani family that has called Chennai home for decades, the architecture serves as a canvas that merges family history, contemporary living and a bold appreciation for colour, craft and distinct character.

Honouring Memory

The house stands on the exact footprint of the family's former residence. Rather than attempting a literal recreation of the past, we chose to carry its spirit forward through quieter, more nuanced architectural gestures. The family's deep-rooted connection to Rajasthan lives on in their inherited treasures, warm hospitality and love for fine craftsmanship. Meanwhile, Chennai expresses itself in the natural tempo of their everyday lives. Having lived between these two cultural landscapes for generations, the family felt no need to separate them. They have organically woven together to define the meaning of home.

Choreography of Layers

Our design takes its cues directly from how the family interacts with space on a daily basis. We intentionally structured the layout so that nothing is completely exposed at first glance. A custom-layered teak entrance door, accented with intricate brass detailing, sets the geometric tone for the interiors. Above, a structured, gridded ceiling establishes a visual rhythm that flows seamlessly through the joinery, partitions and structural planes. As you step past the threshold, dramatic reveals are replaced by subtle, strategic glimpses. Rooms